Diamante Technical Coaching

TechFuse DSM · 2026

Your Teams Need Learning Time Not More AI Tools

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Founder · Technical Coach · Diamante Technical Coaching



Who am I?

- **Steven Diamante from Raleigh, NC**
  - Founder of Diamante Technical Coaching
  - AI Consultant at Artium AI
- **Avid XP practitioner**
  - pairing
  - TDD
  - refactoring
  - continuous integration
- **Over 2000 hours of Claude Code usage**
  - Building AI with AI in production
- **Hobbies**
  - Plays guitar and sings
  - Meditating for over 6 years
  - Chess and Poker
  - Travels the world with family



Three ideas

- AI amplifies a team’s existing practices
- Teams spread new practices by learning on real work together
- Start with recurring hands-on learning time.

YOU'VE SEEN THIS MOVIE

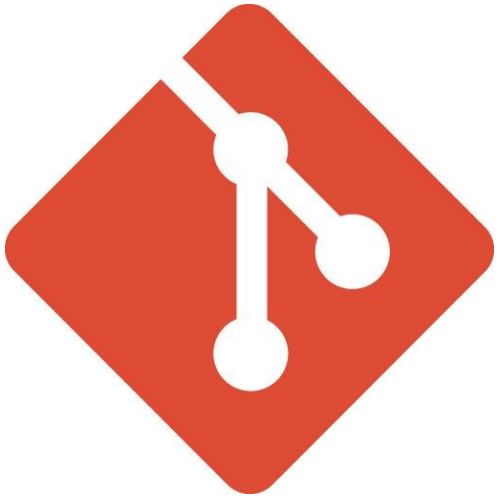
"We need the AI."

Licenses go out. Onboarding is minimal. Standards don't exist. Reviews pile up. Bug rates climb. Merge hell. Leadership did not buy this.

The productivity paradox.

It feels faster. The numbers say otherwise.

Batches were already too big.
AI makes them bigger.



FOR TEAMS STILL REVIEWING PRS

Make review synchronous.

01 Reviewer checks it out and runs it locally. Tests it like QA.

02 Reviewer asks about names, intent, edge cases, out loud.

03 When the author says “I don't know, AI wrote it,” you sit and work out what the code does.

04 Fix issues in real time

More code. More downstream strain.

+72%
Average PR size

+301%
Time in QA

+125%
Monthly incidents

FAROS AI · SPEED TRAP 2026 · 22K DEVELOPERS · 4K TEAMS · 12 MONTHS · CORRELATIONAL



AI doesn't fix a team. It amplifies what's already there.

DORA · STATE OF DEVOPS 2025 · "A MIRROR AND A MULTIPLIER"

Agents write our code

Engineers still need to understand the system

WHY LEARN TOGETHER?

Learning builds shared capability.

Shared context | Taste | Less rework | Reusable practices

Every session spreads context and judgment beyond one person. The next task starts with more people ready to contribute.

WHAT TO LEARN

Build fluency in four areas.

01 Domain: users, product goals, business rules.

02 System: architecture, boundaries, prior decisions.

03 Agents: context, decomposition, verification.

04 Engineering: TDD, DDD, refactoring, mutation testing.

Three adoption patterns

Poor → better → best.

PATTERN 01

"We have AI, now use it."

Licenses deployed. Workflows unchanged. Everyone stays solo. Adoption counted as success.

POSSIBLE OUTCOME

RISK: NO MEASURED CHANGE

PATTERN 02

Volunteer demos, siloed work.

A senior runs bi-weekly demos. Good ideas surface, then evaporate. The work itself is still solo.

POSSIBLE OUTCOME

CHAMPION MAY BURN OUT.

PATTERN 03

Social programming on real code.

Pairing and ensemble sessions in production code with agents in the loop. Workflows spread by active engagement and experimentation.

POSSIBLE OUTCOME

It can compound.

PATTERN 01 · POOR

"We have AI. Now use it."

Leadership bought licenses. The box is checked. The team's operating model is untouched.

01 No onboarding, no standards, no shared rituals.

02 Same workflow. New tool.

03 Dashboards celebrate seat count.

04 Downstream signals do not move. Not quality. Not throughput. Not morale.

> **POSSIBLE OUTCOME → RISK:**
>
> **MORE DOWNSTREAM STRAIN.**

PATTERN 02 · BETTER

Volunteer demos, siloed delivery.

A motivated senior starts a bi-weekly AI demo slot. Good intentions. Wrong altitude.

01 Knowledge lives in the room for an hour, then evaporates.

02 The work itself is still solo, still hidden in branches.

03 Attendance is opt-in, so learning is opt-in.

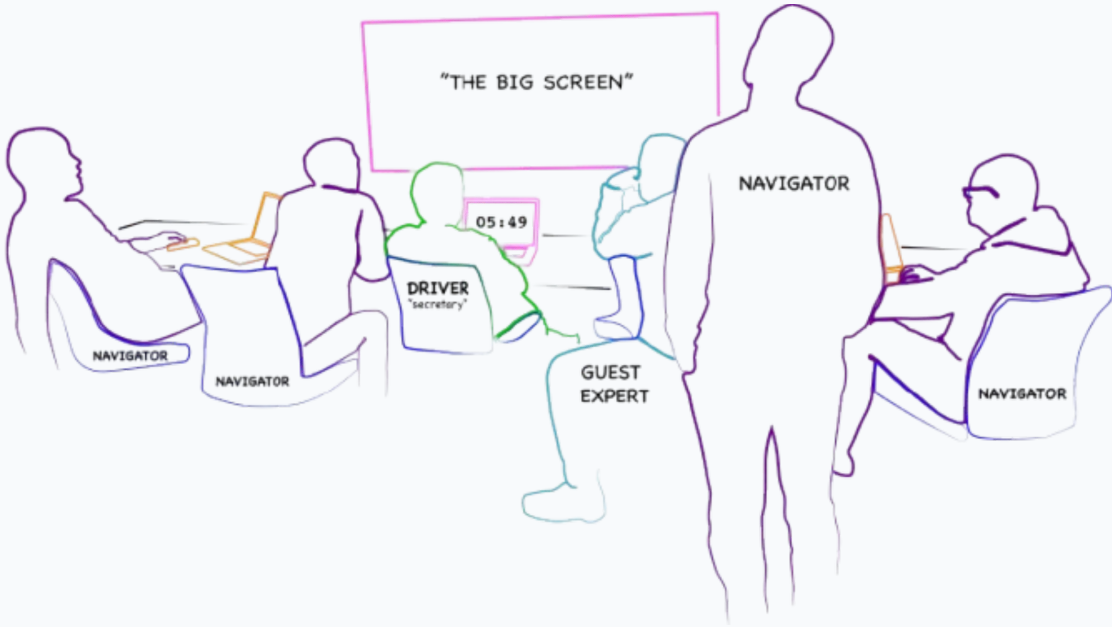
04 The volunteer senior may burn out.

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POSSIBLE OUTCOME → AI CHAMPION MAY BURN OUT

THE DEMO SERIES MAY FADE.
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AI EN·SEM·BLE *noun, practice*

"All the brilliant minds, working on the same thing, at the same time, in the same space , on the same computer. With AI as a full participant."



COLAB AI · MAARET PYHÄJÄRVI & CO. · 2025

PATTERN 03 · BEST

Social programming on real code.

Pairing. Ensembles. Agents in the loop. Review happens while we work.

01 Same problem, same time, shared keyboard.

02 Review happens live, not three days later in a PR.

03 Seniors coach by doing, not documenting.

04 Good prompts, skills, and context get captured as they're discovered.

> POSSIBLE OUTCOME → PRACTICES CAN SPREAD.
>
> LEARNING CAN STICK. EACH SESSION CAN BUILD ON THE LAST.

ONE CONDITION. NON-NEGOTIABLE.

AI ensemble only works with guardrails

- Rigorous automated tests
- Linters
- Type checks
- Merciless refactoring

Guardrails help keep the code reliable.
Guardrails support shared quality.

When everyone works solo, one person becomes the bottleneck



SENIOR AI-PR CLEANUP

AI output → review → QA / rework

Review capacity can become the constraint.

From one person’s workflow to a team’s way of working

A client story → the one practice → how to diagnose your team.

From Scrum silos to an agent skills marketplace.

TWO MONTHS · 2 TO 3 TEAMS A WEEK · LEAN COFFEES + WORKING SESSIONS ON REAL TICKETS.

BEFORE

MONTH 0

Solo devs, standups only.

Classic Scrum cadence. Work happened in isolation. Ideas stayed on the person who had them.

KNOWLEDGE MOVES AT SPRINT-REVIEW SPEED

→

AFTER

MONTH 2

Collaboration in every form. Skills shared across teams.

Ensembling in working sessions. Social programming between them, team by team. Agent skills published to a shared internal marketplace.

SHARED SKILLS → AVAILABLE ACROSS TEAMS

Teams now contribute to a shared skills marketplace. Not from licenses. From collaboration.

THE ONE THING · IF YOU TAKE NOTHING ELSE

2 hours a week. Hands on the keyboard. Agent in the loop. Real code.

01 Demo a new open-source agentic tool you've been trying.

02 Demo a new skill or subagent you built this week.

03 Work a real ticket together. So much learning and KT from this.

04 Create shared skills as a team. Everyone's agent benefits.

So which pattern is your team in?

Answer each honestly. The side you land on tells you where you are.

01 How do our agents behave across the team?

`EVERYONE FREESTYLES → P01 / P02`
No shared rules, prompts, or skills.

`SHARED STANDARDS → P03`
One shared playbook. Picked up by working together.

02 When one person finds a great workflow, what happens?

`DIES AT THEIR DESK · OR DEMOED & FORGOTTEN → P01 / P02`
Slack post nobody reads, or a brown bag that never gets adopted.

`SPREADS BY PAIRING → P03`
Captured as a shared skill. In use by tomorrow.

03 Where is your senior bandwidth going?

`CLEANING UP AI PRs → P01 / P02`
Reviewing and fixing code they didn't write.

`TEACHING LIVE → P03`
Coaching happens in pairs and ensembles, not in PR review.

Diamante Technical Coaching

Put recurring learning time on the calendar.

diamantetechcoaching.com



Feedback



Slides